



Kandy Esala Perahera

Also known as the "Festival of the Tooth," this annual event in the city of Kandy pays tribute to a relic said to be the Buddha's tooth. Decorated elephants join dancers and acrobats in processions.



- 📏 25,332 sq miles (65,610 sq km)
- 👤 22.9 million
- ★ Sri Jayewardenepura Kotte, Colombo
- 🗣️ Sinhala, Tamil, Sinhala-Tamil, English



Sri Lanka



Asia

The lion represents the strength of the nation.

Stilt fishing

These Sri Lankan fishermen perch on wooden stilts high over shallow waters to catch fish. Generations of families have used this technique.

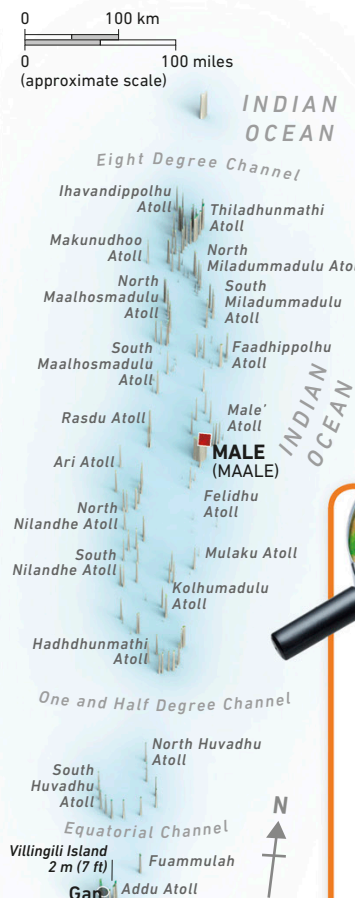


The **island country** of Sri Lanka lies off the **southern tip** of **India**. Its location in the **Indian Ocean** has attracted **traders** since ancient times. Today, the country is known for its **tea plantations** and **wildlife**.



Underwater cabinet meeting

In 2009, the Maldives government made history by holding the world's first underwater cabinet meeting to promote action against rising water levels and climate change.



Maldives



Malé

One-third of the population inhabits the capital city of Malé, taking up a whole island in the Malé atoll.



- 📏 115 sq miles (298 sq km)
- 👤 392,000
- ★ Malé
- 🗣️ Dhivehi, other languages (+3)

Famous for their picture-perfect **tropical beaches** and **clear waters**, the **flat, low-lying Maldives** risk being submerged by **rising sea levels**. This archipelago consists of **more than 1,000 coral islands**, grouped into **26 atolls**.